

John de la Garza

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Systems Engineer with a passion for programming, discovery, and problem solving. I have worked on things from low-level code to distributed systems and everything in between.

Over the last year I have started using AI tools more frequently for large parts of the software development process. For example: RFCs, specifications, test plans, implementation. As well as debugging and root cause analysis for issues that span many systems.

SKILLS

- **domain:** Linux, distributed systems, cloud infrastructure, backend
- **language:** Python, Go, SQL, Rust, Bash, C, Perl, Lua, JavaScript, Ruby, Lisp
- **technology:** AWS, Kubernetes, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Nginx, Flask, WebSockets, SQLAlchemy, Netbox, FastAPI, Prometheus, Grafana, Django

WORK EXPERIENCE

Cloudflare, remote, Systems Engineer

6/2024 to 5/2026

- Owned and maintained the asset ingestion system that pulls asset data from vendor APIs and creates corresponding records in Netbox. Onboarded new vendors end-to-end: defining schemas and specs, coordinating with vendors on data format and delivery, and collaborating with cross-functional teams internally.
- Automated hardware vendor asset ingestion, replacing a manual spreadsheet-upload process so assets appeared in Netbox automatically, eliminating significant toil for the hardware team.
- Automated rack-integrator data ingestion to eliminate manual tracking and spreadsheet reconciliation for a complex multi-party asset hand-off flow.
- Built a self-service UI component in the Netbox plugin enabling users to create hardware part-number to model-number mappings, eliminating manual spreadsheet-based ticket workflows.
- Built a reconciliation system which kept our asset data source of truth synchronized with what the hardware was reporting. Devices would run agents which would publish device state to a message bus. Reconciler would subscribe to the bus and detect diffs between device-reported state and Netbox. Updates would be made if the data was easy to update, otherwise a person would be notified.
- Wrote test coverage for all new code and refactored existing code in the Netbox plugin and asset ingestion system, reducing mocking overhead and improving test execution speed.
- Supported network engineers as part of a regular on-call rotation, troubleshooting provisioning issues with root cause analysis.

Blackberry, remote, Senior Software Engineer

4/2019 to 9/2023

- Led design and development of a REST API backend for an enterprise security product, spanning feature work, bug fixes, deployments, and operations. Development was done mostly in Go and Python.
- First responder for customer-facing incidents, tracking root causes across distributed services and deploying fixes.
- Frequently pair programmed with others that were newer to the job to get them up to speed on using git consistently and learning how to run/develop/debug the different microservices.
- Transitioned several services from Python to Go.
- Used OpenResty/Lua to build a bidirectional WebSocket gateway routing messages between customer devices, Kinesis streams, and internal HTTP microservices via pub/sub.

Comscore, Portland, OR, Senior Software Engineer 11/2016 to 12/2018

- Worked on a distributed system that counted watched ads and determined who watched them, handling data ingestion, normalization, summarization, and export pipelines.
- Built composable command-line tools that acted as a query language for analyzing incoming data and generating custom reports.

Idealist.org, Portland, OR, Senior Developer 7/2015 to 7/2016

- Worked on a team creating a REST API that needed to inter-operate with an existing model, database, and messaging system. It provided HTTPS endpoints to allow other systems to post jobs in an automated fashion. This involved doing a deep dive into the code to fully understand the existing architecture.
- Created a new system that allowed customers to bulk post job listings. It was available to the end users as a REST API where they could submit jobs, check status, etc. It was consistent, well-documented, and designed to be discoverable.
- Wrote shell scripts to create a chroot-based sandbox. This provided a reproducible development environment on individual developer computers.

EDUCATION

Cal State Fullerton, BA Management Information Systems, Dean's List

SPOKEN LANGUAGES

English and Spanish